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INTL601

Midterm Examination

Section 1: -

- 1) Realism in Donnelly: "According to Jack Donnelly's discussion of Realism, how does Kenneth Waltz's structural realism differ from classical realism?"

To be able to answer this question it's important to first define what Realism is as an international relations theory. Realpolitik, often known as Political realism, is among the earliest and widely recognized school of thought in international relations According to Jack Donnelly's definition in the book, Realism is a theoretical paradigm in international relations that focuses on the challenges that nation-states encounter while using power politics to preserve their national interests (Donnelly, 2005). It's imperative to note that Classical Realism and Structural realism hold similar core outlook or rather views about how the world is. Both classical realism and Structural realism emphasize that states are rational entities seeking to maximize their own self-interest (which means here their domestic national interests) through accumulation of more power, making sure they have acquired the highest form of security, to guarantee their survival in an anarchic international system that lacks an overarching authority to check and balance each states conduct (Donnelly, 2005). In addition, both hold the core premise of state centrism. The state is of utmost significance in international relations, everything else is to an extent irrelevant. So, Anarchy and Egoism are the fundamental values of realism, and they are necessary for understanding how international relations work. Both elements result in a constant struggle for dominance, and power (Donnelly, 2005).

When it comes to morality, Classical Realism and Structural Realism do not promote immorality but rather regard themselves as Amoral. Rather they introduce “*Raison d'état*” or the reason of the state claiming that the state needs to take precedence beyond moral concerns. Since there is no overarching authority in the international realm, states are put in a position of self-help system, pushing them to react in what can be seen as immoral or rather without consideration of universal ethical values (Donnelly, 2005). They contend that conflict is unavoidable; it can be controlled, however it is not entirely eradicated. Nations may only strive for existence within a quite bit less hazardous environment instead of an environment that is tranquil. Moreover, both classical Realists and Structural Realists emphasize the downside of cooperation due to the actor's emphasis on relative gains in the international realm which has the potential to hinder any process of cooperation (Donnelly, 2005).

However, here is where Classical realists and the Waltzian Structural realism diverge in assumptions. Classical Realism assigns nearly the same importance to mankind's innate traits as well as the lack of overarching authority in the international system also referred to as Anarchy (Donnelly, 2005). However, Classical realists argue that humans' intrinsic selfishness is what reflects the way nations engage with other countries in an international system that is anarchic. Every human comes into being carrying a natural, inherent urge to exert influence towards others in addition to constantly searching for methods that will boost their own status. Acquiring authority is the fundamental goal among every state and individual. So, this translates to us that power according to Classical realists, is an end (Morgenthau, 1948). In Donnelly's chapter, classical realism put emphasis on Thomas Hobbes Views regarding the state of nature. He introduces the concept of Logic of Interaction, which asserts that if identical agents engage in anarchy, out of competitiveness, distrust, as well as prestige, widespread aggressive disputes may arise. Hobbes has a lot of doubts about changing human nature. War, therefore, is unavoidable (Donnelly, 2005).

Structural Realism, on the other hand, is reflected in Donnelly's chapter which talks about Waltz structural Realism. Structural realism seeks to separate out every variable within a sovereign nation apart from the capabilities they hold. These variables, within this instance, refer to the sovereign nation's belief system, its style of governance, whether democratic, authoritarian, or totalitarian, as well as the overall characteristics of the ruler (president), and only focus on the instrumental aspect, that is the nation's capability in terms of economic performance, strength, and the security forces (Waltz, 1979). When nations engage with one another, a global framework develops that both stimulates as well as restricts their ability to undertake certain measures. The global political framework is characterized by dual ordering principle; Hierarchy (reflection of domestic politics of the nation-state), and Anarchy which is the lack of an overarching Authority to check and balance over Nation-states worldwide; division of roles, which talks about the form of governance each state has whether democratic or socialist; lastly the distribution of capabilities (Waltz, 1979) .The Hierarchical political order and the division of roles. (reflecting the domestic political activities within a nation-state) does not dictate the way nation-states behave in the international system, reinforces the idea that they are irrelevant. So, it's important to shed light on only how power is dispersed amongst the major key players in the international system, which reflects how they behave with one another. Overall, structural realism of Waltz proposes that it's not mankind's inherent qualities that dictates how states behave with one another in the international realism, in contrast with Classical Realists, but it is the structure of the global farmwork being anarchic that compels states to accumulate as much power and dominance to be able to survive (Waltz, 1979; Donnelly, 2005).

- 2) Liberal Internationalism: "What are the core tenets of Liberal Internationalism post-Cold War, as outlined by [Burchill](#)?"

Most contemporary industrialized environments have been significantly influenced by liberalism as a framework of global relations. It has advocated for restricted authority and objective reasoning, thinking that citizens ought to be insulated from coercive government authority, oppression even prejudice. Liberalism advocated for freedom of expression, the rule of law, and legally secured liberties, while emphasizing freedom for everyone, everyone should be equal before the law. They additionally advocated about private competition precisely within civil communities and asserted that free-market economy allocates the restricted assets among individuals in an exceptionally effective way, consequently improving the well-being for everyone (Burchill, 2005). Scott Burchill outlines the fundamental principles of liberal internationalism following the termination of the Cold War in his chapter entitled liberalism. It quickly became apparent that liberal ideologies gained more traction following the Cold War and the Soviet Union's dissolution throughout the 1990s. In his well-known book *The End of History*, Fukuyama asserted that liberal democracy lacked significant ideological rivals around the precise moment of the conclusion of the Cold War owing to the dissolution of the USSR. He believed that liberal democracy was the pinnacle of human political development — the ultimate kind of administration. The transformation of the African continent, the east Asian region, and South America into becoming democratic areas constituted a clear indication of this (Burchill, 2005). According to Fukuyama, the conclusion of the Cold War signified the victory of the perfect nation, and a specific type of political economy referred to as liberal capitalist system, which he maintains will not be enhanced on as well as its the pinnacle of advancement of fundamental structures and standards (Fukuyama, 1992). Liberals believe this past is directional therefore liberal democracy has become the trajectory that humanity's entire history is on. Liberals emphasize how state-level internal structures will resemble external structures at the global-level. When governments integrate liberal democracies

into their internal politics, they eradicate every kind of international warfare thus characterizing humanity's path in the direction of prosperity. Doyle believes that liberal democratic entities have the capacity to refrain from employing aggression throughout their interactions towards other democratic nations. In general, liberalism approaches international affairs from the inside out (Burchill, 2005). Doyle claims that expanding the zone of peaceful countries that have successfully worked out ways to settle their disagreements without going to war is an extremely essential component that constitutes setting after communism. (Doyle, 1986; Burchill, 2005). It is extremely improbable for nations to engage in fight alongside other countries as long as they advocate analogous liberal democratic values within their borders since they will recognize their respective sovereignty (Burchill, 2005; Fukuyama, 1992). The liberal perspective on peace holds that it can last forever. War is illogical and unpleasant. Liberals claim that they possess a strong belief in the validity of human logic and the capability of people to reach their full capabilities without succumbing to violence. Every liberal academic holds that military and unjust administrations started battles to further their respective agendas (Burchill, 2005). It is evident that liberal democracies are not particularly interested in confrontation when it comes to their dedication to the rule of law, citizens liberties and equal treatment before the law, and democratic processes founded on public agreement (Burchill, 2005). A separate peace has been established by them (Doyle 1986; Fukuyama, 1992). One could consider this to be the Democratic Peace theory (Doyle 1986, 1995). As stated by liberals, there are two ways to approach war. Commerce without barriers and democratization (Burchill, 2005). The theory of comparative advantage contends that open trade will ultimately result in significant enhancement for any economy compared to its previous state of independence as well as patriotism. In general, interconnected partnerships brought about by commerce that is free promote interpersonal communication and prevent dispute (Burchill, 2005). Why would economically dependent states go to war with each other, especially if they are

working through institutions? Of course, globalization, which arose during the Cold War, served to encourage capitalism, disseminate established norms, and reduce state authority, all of which liberals enjoy seeing. Human rights became another important principle of liberalism following the Cold War. Liberals have traditionally considered that the legitimacy of nation-state governments depended heavily on sustaining the rule of law and the government's commitment toward its citizens' fundamental freedoms. People who commit crimes have to be accountable for their illicit conduct, and governments are also held accountable if they engage in wrongdoing via foreign policy. Governments that uphold their citizens' freedom and provide them with opportunities to become involved in politics are not as prone to engage in confrontational conduct on the world stage (Burchill, 2005). Overall, human rights, liberal democracy, liberal economy (open trade and business), and institutionalism are all concepts or beliefs that emerged following the Cold War.

3) Critical Theory by Linklater: "What role does the 'politics of knowledge' play in shaping IR according to Linklater?"

Concerns about the politics of knowledge wouldn't have been given much attention in the discipline of international relations up until the 1980s, when the third debate began. To construct a conceptual framework that allows one to illustrate on the essence and objectives of concepts and identify hidden as well as overt manifestations of discrimination and dominance through the community, critical thought requires inspiration from a variety of occidental, political, cultural, and philosophical perspectives. According to critical theory, true freedom has yet to be reached, and to emancipate, something must be done, a type of human agency, to be free of the prevailing structures that confine human freedom. Change is occurring inside society, and it is imminent. Critical theory is intent on questioning and criticizing how things are (Devetak, 2005; Linklater, 2005). Critical theory was meant to investigate the fundamental social frameworks that are

involved in these injustices with the goal of transcending them. Critical theorists criticize earlier theorists, stating that they only accomplished a single task: describe or analyze what is happening, whereas the major objective is to alter it. The desire to explore the prospects of accomplishing freedom in contemporary society necessitated thorough assessments regarding both obstacles and the immanent inclinations toward the logical structuring of human behavior (Devetak, 2005; Linklater, 2005). Critical theorists recognize that Rational theorists' goal is to develop knowledge which is highly political and culturally developed with the objective to advance the purposes associated with interests throughout the community, which is then mirrored in the international arena. In contrast to critical theorists, Rational theorists are not focused on the link across knowledge and community. Due to this, critical theorists acknowledged the political element of knowledge (Devetak, 2005). Traditional theories depict the researcher being separate from the object of investigation. To effectively hypothesize, the object and subject must be carefully segregated. Therefore, theorizing is only conceivable if an enquiring subject can withdraw from the circumstance under study and clear itself of any prejudices. This contradicts the critical theorists' assumptions, who view that value-free evaluation of society is important (Devetak, 2005). Traditional or problem-solving theories analyze the external environment objectively, without considering the mind of humans. According to Cox, problem -solving paradigm accepts the environment in which it sees it, focusing on widespread social and economic interpersonal dynamics of power including the institutions toward how they have been structured serving as the foundation for conduct. Instead of challenging the current structure, it serves to legitimize as well as solidify it (Cox, 1981). The objective of critical theory, compared to traditional thought, is to enhance the lives of people through removing inequality. As a result, critical theorists agree that thoughts are culturally specific as well as consequently, susceptible to political objectives, therefore should be subject to scrutiny. In general, interpretations of global relations, such as any

knowledge, are inevitably controlled through historical, cultural, as well as philosophical, impact, which means that one of the primary goals of critical thinking has become to uncover the implications of this programming (Devetak, 2005). Knowledge is always constructed in accordance with objectives and beliefs as well as interest which provide origin to every paradigm which is reflected in the study of international relations (Ashley, 1981). Overall, critical theorists produce knowledge that cannot be considered impartial; it is both politically and morally driven through their thirst for improvements in society and politics. It examines along with invalidates views which validate the present arrangement and advocates constructive approaches which support freedom and emancipation (Devetak, 2005).

- 4) Constructivism in Reus-Smit: "According to Reus-Smit, how does anarchy differ based on social interactions and shared norms? Provide a quote from the assigned readings to support your answer."

Constructivism is an innovative approach in international relations discipline, which stresses the interpersonal relationships of individuals / actors throughout contemporary world politics. State interaction, as defined by constructivists, is an instructional method where opinions, interests, and ideals become established repeatedly through process or action. Unlike various methods of inquiry, constructivism in society investigates the growth and supervisory impact of globally accepted norms; in simple terms, research strives at connecting underlying organizational frameworks with national identity and objectives. However, the actions of nations along with additional entities perpetually replicate while retaining the capacity to alter structures altogether. Structures and agents have been mutually regulating variables (Griffiths, 2009; Rues-Smit, 2005). States constitute what anarchy is according to Alexander Wendt (Wendt, 1992). Constructivists have a different definition and interpretation of anarchy compared to traditional perspectives. According

to Neorealists (mainstream view), anarchy is the already present permanent framework of the global framework that influences and molds the actions and attitudes of nations toward one another. Anarchy is the reason why states compete for power. And war is inevitable (Waltz, 1979; Rues-Smit, 2005). Nonetheless, constructivists contend that the idea of anarchy is built into society. Anarchy is not the engine of state engagement. The identities, norms, values, and beliefs of states determine their whole identity which they thought were natural, behavior, and how they see one another in the international arena. According to constructivists, material structures are not as significant as normative or ideational structures when regulating the decisions and actions of societal and political agents, whether those agents are states or citizens (Rues-Smit, 2005). According to constructivists, social as well as political conduct is significantly affected by frameworks of common thoughts, opinions, and values which additionally possess structural characteristics. Furthermore, since identities influence interests in turn, constructivists contend that this process is critical to comprehend the way nonmaterial structures influence agents' identities. Agents' interests are externally defined, based on rationalists (mainstream theories like neo-liberalism and neorealism), which means that governments or citizens deal with one another having already established objectives. Rationalist philosophers aren't concerned about how these motivations emerge, rather they are concerned with the way agents deploy these objectives or interests in a tactful manner. Constructivists, on the other hand, want to demonstrate the way interests are generated by emphasizing the identities of both states and citizens. Ideational structures can restrict the identities and interests of agents, yet those structures wouldn't be present without regard for those agents' activities. (Rues-Smit, 2005). According to Wendt, "it's through reciprocal interaction that we create and instantiate the relatively enduring social structures in terms of which we define our identities and interests" (Wendt, 1992, p. 406).

Section 2:-

- 1) Prompt 1: "Compare how Marxism and Critical Theory approach global capitalism. Include arguments from [Griffiths](#), and discuss the influence of global capitalism."

Marxism and critical theory differ little in their worldviews; both are strongly critical of how exploitative mechanisms, such as capitalism, rule the world. Marxism believed that the goal of social research was to promote the liberation of the oppressed proletariat alongside additional subjugated individuals. The Frankfurt School of Critical Theory defends this dedication to emancipatory social science. (Linklater, 2005b). Marx and Engels' views on capitalist globalization, which claim that it is destroying the foundations of the global framework of states, are discussed in Mark Rupert's chapter on Marxism. According to Marx and Engels, the internationalization of capitalism will force a change in the balance of political power. As an instance, capitalism destroys national borders because of the mutually beneficial economic relationship that these governments have created. (Linklater, 2005b; Rupert, 2005). As a result, Marx and Engel anticipated that nations would continue to engage in violent interactions with one another, but that the development of global trade and markets would diminish their importance. They believed that a class conflict between the bourgeoisie, or capitalist class, and the proletariat, or working class, would be the primary cause of international conflict rather than merely rivalry. They regarded capitalism as a sword with two sharp edges. On the one hand, capitalism enables people from many civilizations to interact with one another and has the potential to create a worldwide proletariat in which all people would unite, recognize the exploitation they endure, and transform into socialism. However, the fundamental nature of the capitalist framework exacerbated exploitation. Nevertheless, they saw that Capitalism's disparities will spark a socialist revolution, eventually toppling the capitalist system (Linklater, 2005; Rupert, 2005). Capitalism, as stated by

Marx, is not a continuous web of enslavement, but rather a paradoxical life of contradictory freedom. According to Rupert (2005), the class relations of capitalism imply that, in contrast to slave bondage or feudal serfs bound to the lord's estate, workers are free to sell their labor, but they are also required to do so to the extent that they have no other way of gaining access to the necessary means of production, which capitalism has made the owning class the exclusive private property. According to Marxist theory, class-based power is established, and domestic class divisions are brought about by global capitalism. This class-based power has a significant impact on the political process and the reproduction of interpersonal relationships in general. However, these class-based forces may be ideologically masked in liberal images of a naturalized and privatized sector distinct from the state's formally political domain, portraying these social powers as though they were inherent, despite the fact that they are not subject to democratic oversight. (Rupert, 2005). The explicit focus on social power relations that are inherent in but hidden by the mechanisms of capitalist production and exchange is what gives a Marxist critique of capitalism its critical leverage. Things like commodities act as mediators in social relations under the historical circumstances of capitalism. By portraying their social relationships as neutralized exchanges between privately owned goods, capitalism both divides and disables human producers, even while the societal division of labor under capitalism has united and empowered people collectively like never before. Social relationships are swallowed into a realm of supposedly independent objects (Rupert, 2005). Overall, Marxism criticizes the disparities that capitalism creates inside society. Frequently concealed under the pretense of advancing human freedoms and individual rights when, in fact, it is fueling societal power struggles and inequality. Where the method of production is concentrated in the hands of a few (the bourgeoisie) and the labor power force has nothing to sell to but their labour to those who dominate the means of production. When workers voluntarily sell their labor to those who possess the means of production, it may appear

that they have rights, but in reality, this capitalist system is defrauding and exploiting them. (Rupert, 2005). The capitalists—those who possess the means of production—are endowed with double powers by this whole procedure. First, economic power, in which they command the means of production, manage the entire process, and determine the structure of the wealth created. The subsequent power is entirely social. By making workers extremely dependent on the wages they offer in order to have the ability and chance to exist, capitalists limit the labor force. This illustrates the efforts of Marxist theorists to portray to us how capitalism is a system that is highly exploitive where the bourgeoisie are benefiting off from the working class in an unequal manner (Rupert, 2005). The concept of emancipation—the liberation of individuals from the constraints of the state or any form of dominance—is what unites these critical theorists into a single group. After analyzing the different types of oppression that occur both within and between cultures, the Frankfurt school of thought looked for different ways to change these kinds of situations (Devetak, 2005; Linklater, 2005). They are particularly interested in adopting a technique known as the Immanent Critique. The hypocrisy of society is brought to light by immanent critique, which criticizes from within rather than the outside. Its residents support freedom, equality, and justice, but in reality, they act in ways that are oppressive, degrading, racist, and so on. This throws light on the discrepancies and shows us that people are unable to hold themselves accountable to their principles. Challenge the oppressive practices of the state systems and free the populace from the instruments of oppression that the states use against them are the primary goals of critical theorists. For the Frankfurt school to be able to analyze modern society it's important to understand the historical and social development that they were brought from. Their aim is to understand and identify the root causes of oppression, not to remove it just, and from that they can triumph over them to produce an emancipated society free from all the oppression (Devetak, 2005; Linklater, 2005a). As Horkheimer puts forth, the aim of critical theorists, in contrast with traditional theorists,

is to enhance the way humans live through dismantling inequalities and injustices and providing equality and freedom to all from the restrictions imposed on them (Devetak, 2005; Linklater, 2005a)

The way that Critical Theory views capitalism is both related to and different from Marxist ideas. Through their publications, a social philosophy that adheres to the spirit of Marxism but not its letter has been established (Linklater, 2005a). The Frankfurt School aimed to revive the emancipatory goal without abandoning modernity's perilous aspects or reverting to classical Marxism. According to one scholar, capitalism produced "one dimension man" who was preoccupied with the fulfillment of generated material requirements. However, he also thought that the student actions of the late 1960s and subsequent battles for national liberation alongside socialism in the developing countries were significant attempts to establish a society without injustices (Linklater, 2005a). Habermas, another researcher of critical theory, has concentrated on how attempts to manage capitalist society have led to the "colonization of the life world," or the infiltration of administrative logic into daily existence. However, he sees the possibility of a new sort of society that substitutes the endeavor to administer society and control nature with the endeavor to increase freedom in political movements that support damage to the environment, equal opportunity for women, and the safety of humans (Linklater, 2005a). Ultimately, their shared goal is to draw attention to existing discrepancies and critically assess them with the objective of eliminating injustices that influence the world community. To uncover the worldwide barriers to achieving liberation and freedom for humanity, critical theorists seek to improve our understanding of what the community genuinely is (Linklater, 2005a). By encouraging a dedication to justice and offering the means to comprehend power dynamics, it opposes global capitalism. (Linklater, 2005a).

Section 3: -

- 1) Analyze a territorial dispute using one IR theory; describe motivations, actions, outcomes. Include relevant quotes from assigned readings to support your analysis.

Russian President Vladimir Putin's seizure of the Crimean Peninsula from Ukraine in early 2014 was the most consequential decision of he made the moment he was put in power. It's imperative to explain what Motives behind Russia's annexation of Crimea are, the Action it made, and the Outcomes of such invasion after almost 11 years. The International Relations theory used to analyze this case of territorial dispute is Waltz structural Realism using defensive realism. Defensive Realism is the best theory to interpret and analyze the kremlin's motives, actions and outcomes of its territorial acquisition which is interpreted as Russia is trying to protect its Security and National interest. (Waltz, 1979; Treisman, 2016). State-to-state competition is fundamentally a struggle for supremacy, according to Waltz structural realism, and has nothing to do with the fundamental characteristics of humanity. The way states interact with each other in the international arena, in his opinion, is a result of the composition of global frameworks. States cannot be held accountable for their own actions since the international system lacks an all-encompassing authority. Anarchy is the reason why states engage in certain actions. In contrast to Morgenthau's Offensive Realist approach, Waltz structural defensive realism describes how states act in the international system. According to defensive realists, states are more interested in maintaining the status quo than changing it. Instead of maximizing power, they prioritize security (Waltz, 1979). It is necessary to state that Russia's attempt to safeguard its security and interests in the area is what motivated it to annex the Crimean Peninsula. Russia's motive in occupying the peninsula was to avert several potentially catastrophic outcomes: first, the potential for Ukraine's newly elect president to accept membership in the north Atlantic treaty organization, plus the

prospect for Ukraine to force Moscow's Black Sea Fleet out of its established station in Sevastopol. NATO's growth will prove unbearable (Treisman, 2016).

So, the motivation for Russia's defensive action is the perceived risks posed by NATO expansion into its frontiers, and it felt compelled to preserve its borders and the region from Western influence. So, what drove Russia to seize Crimea was concern of NATO expansion and how that growth could jeopardize its security and survival, as well as a desire to counterbalance western hegemony. Of course, if Crimea remained under Ukrainian administration and Ukraine fell under NATO's influence, the economic power of the Sevastopol coast and the Black Sea region may be jeopardized because it is strategically important to the Kremlin (Waltz, 1979; Treisman, 2016). The conclusion of Russia's takeover of Crimea laid the groundwork for its invasion of Ukraine after ten years since Ukraine was loud about its desire to join NATO, felt alarmed by Russia's behavior, and wanted to change its alliance to the west, resulting in a security problem. One counterpart's increase in security poses a threat to the other. Which is exactly what transpired between Ukraine and Russia. The other effect is that Russia has received huge blowback from the West in the form of heavy sanctions aimed at damaging Russia's economy (Treisman, 2016). Defensive realists say that having a predisposition to imperialize and diversify causes offsetting attitudes among governments, as evidenced by the effects of the annexation of the Crimean peninsula (Waltz, 1979).

Section 4:-

- 1) How do Waltz's structural realism and Reus-Smit's Constructivism differ on anarchy? Provide specific references from the readings to support your answer."

The introduction of structural realism followed World War II, when he came to the realization that states' actions were determined by the international system's structure rather than by their arrogant nature. Therefore, states are primarily concerned with their own survival due to the anarchic

structure of the international system and the lack of a central authority that commands and holds states accountable for the actions they take (Waltz, 1979). Waltz continued by arguing that nations should increase their military might in order to minimize the relative advantages of their enemies and to increase their own security and survival. Those nations are "defensive positionalist," according to Waltz. Being aware of their place in the hierarchy of power among states, they want to either retain or elevate their position to the point of leadership (Rues-Smit, 2005; Donnelly, 2005). As a result, Waltz argued that the battle for power is a lasting feature of international affairs, and violence is chronic. He contended that collaboration between governments is tenuous or impossible in such a society. Because power is the ultimate guarantee of survival, neorealists contend that nations continuously measure their power versus that of other states, and anarchy causes states worry for their existence. Their skepticism about cooperation stems from this. All they are concerned with is relative benefits. States have independent identities and interests. According to structural realists, society is a strategic arena where people or governments organize to pursue their own predetermined objectives and interests (Rues-Smit, 2005; Donnelly, 2005). As a result, actors are not social by nature; rather, they are atomistic logical individuals who establish interpersonal interactions for the purpose of furthering their own agendas. Structural Realists have little interest in how interests are forged (Rues-Smit, 2005). Contrarily, constructivism holds that social systems influence the conduct of those in politics and society and that anarchy is socially produced. Since social actors' social identities are believed to be shaped by normative and ideational systems, they emphasize their significance. Even though both countries coexist with the United States, a material equilibrium of influence among Canada and the United States as well as Cuba and the United States has drastically different implications due to views regarding identity, the reasoning of ideology, and longstanding systems of friendliness and antagonism. Constructivists, who contend that structures that characterize identities also inform interests,

disagree that anarchy ought to dictate how states act. Constructivists, unlike Structural Realists, are concerned with exploring the origins and methods of interest and how they are forged. Interests do not come out of the blue, rather they are formed. According to Wendt's words "identities are the basis of interest" (Wendt, 1992). Chris-Rues Smit is particularly interested in understanding how norms, identities, and values evolve over time, which is why he focuses on historical analysis of how these interests emerged and later shaped identities. (Griffiths, 2009). State behavior in the international domain is guided by deeply rooted social norms, not by the fact that the international system exists organically. Communication and the actions of individuals can transform and change global political frameworks that influence how nations view one another. However, Rues contends that it is critical to examine not just the way norms and moral principles manage and shape state identity and authority, but also how they developed because of talks and agreements throughout international institutions (Griffiths, 2009).

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